



MONERO LAUNCHES

025 / 18 APR 2014 / MONERO / RARE

PRIVACY FOR ALL.

A warm lamp hangs above the stall. A customer and a seller face each other across fruit, fabric and everyday clutter, while the market carries on behind them. LORE puts privacy in the middle of ordinary life: a payment between two people who do not need to share their whole financial history with everyone passing by.

The Monero blockchain went live on 18 April 2014, initially under the name BitMonero. Its launch had been announced in advance on BitcoinTalk, and the project began without a premine or token sale. Built on CryptoNote technology, it took a different approach to transaction privacy from Bitcoin's openly traceable ledger. The shorter name, Monero, followed later that month as the community began shaping the project.

CryptoNote's design combined one-time destination keys with ring signatures, aiming to make payments harder to link and their source harder to identify. Those foundations should not be confused with every protection Monero later acquired. Minimum ring-size requirements and Ring Confidential Transactions arrived through subsequent upgrades; RingCT, which conceals transaction amounts, was enabled in 2017. The launch began a continuing effort, rather than completing a promise of perfect anonymity.

The market gives that ambition a human scale. Privacy here is room to conduct an ordinary transaction without turning a person into a trail for spectators to follow. A tray of plain tokens suggests the related goal of fungibility: units of money that can be treated interchangeably. The awnings divide the crowded scene into small pockets of personal space, while the seller's lamp keeps the exchange itself clear and approachable.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 CRYPTONOTE ON THE SHELF

The book names the technology behind Monero's beginnings. Its binding and market placement are fictional, but the connection to CryptoNote is historical and central to the launch.

02 THE AWNING SPIRAL

The large spiral on the red awning foreshadows the later Tornado Cash privacy debate. This intentionally forward-looking motif makes a thematic connection; it does not claim shared founders, code or organisational ties.

03 FOOTPRINTS ON WET STONE

The prints introduce the idea of a trace. They are a visual metaphor for transaction trails and the privacy questions Monero addresses, without claiming perfect anonymity or the removal of every trace.

04 TOKENS IN THE TRAY

The tray holds many interchangeable-looking tokens, a visual metaphor for fungibility. They are not physical Monero coins or a reconstruction of how a launch-day payment occurred.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

The [original BitcoinTalk announcement](#) and [Monero's technical specifications](#) establish the launch; the project's [history](#) and [roadmap](#) distinguish later upgrades. The [CryptoNote paper](#) explains the underlying privacy approach. The market, people and props are symbolic, with no claim of guaranteed anonymity. PRIVACY FOR ALL is editorial copy. The spiral deliberately looks forward.